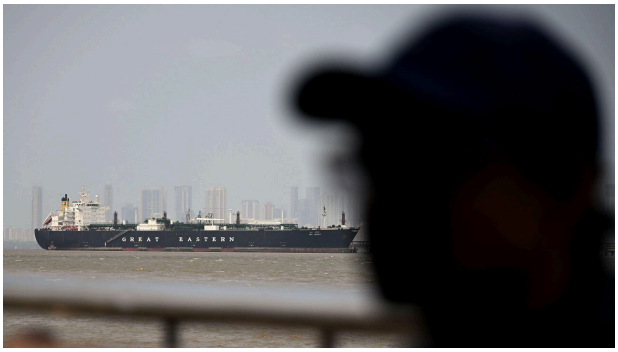
The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter



Photograph: Alamy

Iran declared the Strait of Hormuz "completely open" to commercial shipping. **Donald Trump** confirmed the move on social media, though he said America's blockade of ships linked to Iran would remain in place. Iran has tied the strait's reopening to a fragile ceasefire in Lebanon, and passage remains tightly controlled. Energy supplies are expected to stay under pressure for months.

Oil traders welcomed the announcement. Brent crude fell below $90 a barrel for the first time in over a month. European natural-gas prices dropped by more than 5%, while the dollar fell. Gains spread to broader markets: the S&P 500 climbed 1.2%, having hit record highs earlier in the week, and the Nasdaq 100 extended its winning streak to 13 days.

Mr Trump appears to be taking a direct role in the **Lebanese ceasefire**, writing on social media that **Israel** is "PROHIBITED" from bombing Lebanon. He said America would work with Lebanon to deal with Hizbullah, the Iranian-backed militia. Israeli troops remain in southern Lebanon despite the ceasefire. Hizbullah's parliamentary bloc said it would respect the truce but sharply criticised the government for agreeing to it.

OnlyFans is set to sell a minority stake to **Architect Capital,** an American investor, in a deal which values the company at more than $3bn. The platform, which is best known for its adult content, has sought investment recently, a process made harder by the death of its owner last month. The partnership is expected to help the site's content creators access banking services more easily.

Uber increased its stake in **Delivery Hero**, a food-delivery company, in a deal worth €270m ($318m). The shares are being sold by Prosus, the German firm's largest shareholder, to comply with the **European Commission's** competition rules after it bought Just Eat, another food-delivery firm, last year. Uber has pledged to expand into seven new European markets, targeting $1bn in additional revenue.

Spain and **Brazil** signed 15 agreements—covering critical minerals, telecoms and artificial intelligence—during talks between Pedro Sánchez and Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva in Barcelona. The meeting coincided with a gathering of leaders from Latin America, Africa and Europe hosted by Mr Sánchez. It aimed to strengthen ties among countries pushing back against America's increasingly interventionist foreign policy.

Tens of thousands marched in Lisbon to protest planned labour reforms by **Portugal's** centre-right government. The changes aim to lift weak productivity, but unions say they would erode protections by expanding outsourcing and curbing overtime pay. The proposals have already sparked a general strike and widespread opposition. The draft law is still under consultation before going to parliament.

Figure of the day: $25bn, the value of oil and gas infrastructure destroyed in the Gulf since the war in Iran began. Explore how the conflict is clouding the investment outlook of the region's sovereign wealth funds.

Photograph: AFP

Lebanon on edge

Celebratory gunfire rang out above Beirut as a ceasefire between Israel and Hizbulla came into effect after nearly six weeks of fighting. The truce gives Lebanon's government ten days to take meaningful steps to disarm the Iran-backed militant group. It also calls for negotiations on a border agreement between Israel and Lebanon. Hizbullah acknowledged the truce, which it credited Iran with brokering.

Donald Trump announced the agreement, and America's State Department published the details. Much remains unclear: the deal makes no mention of an Israeli withdrawal from Lebanon (Israel says its army will remain in the south), and allows Israel the right to strike targets in Lebanon "in self-defence, at any time". Despite the uncertainty, within moments of the ceasefire taking hold, roads south of Lebanon's capital filled with people attempting to return home. More than a million were displaced as Israel razed several villages along the border, and killed over 2,000 in strikes.

Photograph: dpa

Europe’s trade fix

Europe is grappling with higher energy prices again. A boost from global trade could help its economy weather the storm. On Friday Eurostat, the EU’s statistics bureau, reported a goods trade surplus of €11.5bn ($13.5bn) for the euro area in February, compared with a deficit of €1bn in January. The shift was mostly driven by the machinery and vehicles sector, where the surplus rose from €1.5bn to €10.2bn. Worldwide, goods trade has been growing by about 7% over the last four quarters, compared to the preceding four, according to the UN figures.

Yet the recovery is fragile. The euro area’s surplus is far lower than it was this time last year, when it was €23.1bn. The chemicals sector has taken the largest hit; its surplus fell to €16.2bn in February, down from €30.4bn a year earlier. Trade with its neighbours has also declined. European trade may have turned a corner but the road ahead remains precarious.

Photograph: Getty Images

The NBA courts Europe

The National Basketball Association, a North American juggernaut, is determined to go global. In 2019 it co-founded the Basketball Africa League, a continental competition. Now the NBA is coming to Europe. It is seeking investors to launch new teams in European cities such as London, Paris and Milan. The NBA is also courting teams who compete in the EuroLeague, a 68-year-old tournament whose final round of regular-season games takes place on Friday.

EuroLeague executives are wary. The teams are more open-minded: Real Madrid (a sports club better known for its football team) is holding out on renewing with EuroLeague for another season. A range of outcomes is possible. EuroLeague could succeed in locking in its existing members, denting the NBA's ambitions; the NBA and EuroLeague could merge; or the status and money of the NBA could see teams defect. Expect plenty of action off the court.

Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 GMT on Friday to . We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Friday: Which Greek poet is generally credited as the writer of the Iliad and the Odyssey?

Thursday: Which famous painting was stolen from the Louvre in 1911 and not returned until 1914?

Love your enemies, for they tell you your faults.

Benjamin Franklin